

Ticker: SKE CN

Pro forma Cash: C\$49m

Project: Eskay Creek

Market cap: C\$464m

Price: C\$6.14sh

Country: Canada, BC

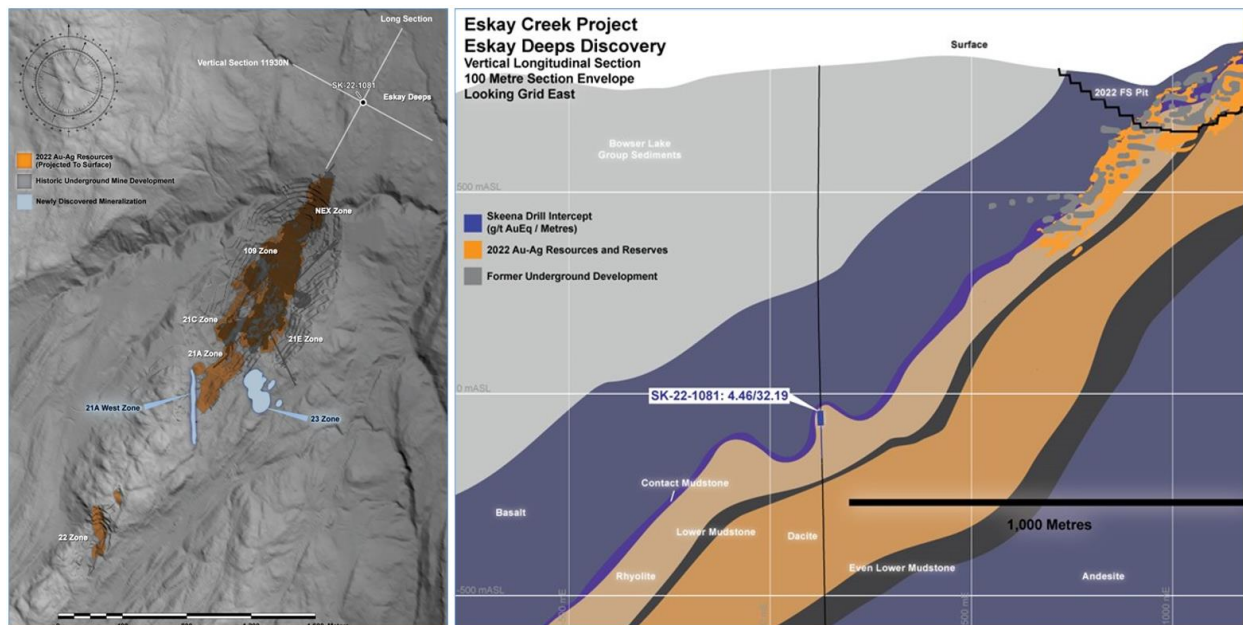
REC. (unc): BUY

TARGET (unc): C\$10.8/sh

RISK RATING (unc): HIGH

Today's Eskay Deeps Discovery, ~650m down-dip of Eskay Creek NEX Zone and 850m down-hole, while not step changing given depth, makes an interesting target for potential UG LOM extensions. We note highlight sub interval 1.0m @ 10.2g/t AuEq leaves a 4.9m @ 4.3g/t halo—above the existing OP reserve grade (4.0g/t) and UG cut-off (2.8g/t), higher-grade than recently reported near-surface 21A West (50.0m @ 2.3g/t) and 23 (96.0m @ 1.2g/t) Zone drilling, albeit below existing UG 5.2g/t AuEq resource. Again, while impressive on grade, we need to bring this to the front of the DCF to be needle moving. So, this is a good strategic addition for now, but NPV is not likely to materially change as reserve conversion pre-year-end-target to finance build (2-3y pre-permit). Regardless, strategic value appears real, while proximity (<1m) to mudstone may add some deleterious elements (Hg/As), more relevant here is that this is a big step-out from historic open stopes and warrants follow-up. As such, **we maintain our BUY rating and C\$10.8/sh PT based on 0.6xNAV<sub>5%-1700</sub>**. Short-term focus continues to be on permitting and funding while 60km step-out and infill drilling continues to derisk and provide near-term news flow.

Figure 1. Eskay Creek (A) Plan view and (B) cross-section showing today's Deeps discovery



Source: Skeena

## New 'Eskay Deeps' Discovery traces mineralization 850m UG; 32.2m @ 4.5g/t AuEq

Results from the first drill hole targeting deep, down-dip, extensions at Eskay Creek hit broad **32.2m @ 4.5g/t AuEq** from 856m down-hole on new "Eskay Deeps Discovery". A total of 26 mineralized sub-intervals ranging from 0.9-1.5m @ 1.0-10.6g/t AuEq were hit, including **1.0m @ 10.6g/t**, **1.0m @ 10.2g/t**, and **1.0m @ 10.1g/t**. Mineralization was identified within rhyolite breccias 4m below a very thin (<1m) unmineralized contact mudstone.

### Why we like Skeena Resources

- Large high-grade open pit with SCPe >500koz upside potential in coming 12-18M
- Shift in market dynamics allows concentrate sales for lower capex
- Optionality from high-grade Snip mine nearby to blend concentrate or add ounces
- Catalyst heavy with drilling, metallurgy, and DFS optimizations in coming 12M

## Catalysts

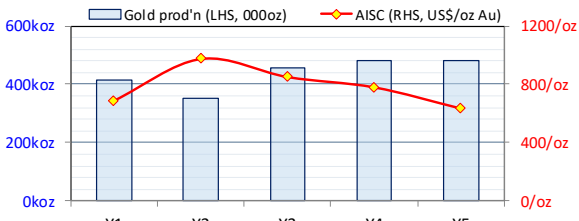
- 2023: permitting updates
- 3Q23: SCPe build start
- CY26: SCPe first production
- 2H22: Exploration and AWF infill / expansion drilling

## Research

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|                                                                                     |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          |                                                  |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------|------------------|---------|---------|
| Ticker: SKE CN<br>Author: B Salier/ E Magdzinski                                    |  | Price / mkt cap: C\$6.14/sh, C\$464m<br>Rec / 0.6xNAV PT: BUY, C\$10.8/sh |                            | Project PNAV today: 0.31x<br>1xNAV3Q22 FF FD: C\$19.61/sh |          | Asset: Eskay Creek / Snip<br>Country: Canada: BC |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Commodity price                                                                     |  | CY18A                                                                     | CY19A                      | CY20A                                                     | CY21A    | CY22E                                            | Resource / Reserve                         | AuEq (koz) | AuEq (g/t)                   |                  |         |         |
| Gold price                                                                          |  | 1,700                                                                     | 1,700                      | 1,700                                                     | 1,700    | 1,700                                            | Pittable resource                          | 5329koz    | 3.20g/t                      |                  |         |         |
| SOTP project valuation*                                                             |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          |                                                  | Underground resource                       | 279koz     | 5.23g/t                      |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | C\$m                                                                      | O/ship                     | NAVx                                                      | C\$/sh   |                                                  | Snip                                       | 646koz     | 13.60g/t                     |                  |         |         |
| Ungeared proj. @ build start (3Q23)                                                 |  | 1,574                                                                     | 100%                       | 1.00x                                                     | 19.05    |                                                  | Funding: uses                              |            |                              | Funding: sources |         |         |
| Pro-forma cash (3Q22 + rse)                                                         |  | 49                                                                        | 100%                       | 1.00x                                                     | 0.59     |                                                  | Build Capex                                | C\$592m    | Pro-forma cash (3Q22 + rse)  | C\$68m           |         |         |
| Cash from options                                                                   |  | 58                                                                        | 100%                       | 1.00x                                                     | 0.71     |                                                  | SCPe G&A to 1st Au + NSR buyback           | C\$28m     | Mine debt @ 65% gearing      | C\$385m          |         |         |
| Rsr ex rsv @US\$50/oz                                                               |  | 92                                                                        | 100%                       | 1.00x                                                     | 1.12     |                                                  | SCPe pre-production expl'n                 | C\$0m      | Mine build equity at 0.4xNAV | C\$207m          |         |         |
| Snip (US\$75/oz)                                                                    |  | 64                                                                        | 100%                       | 1.00x                                                     | 0.78     |                                                  | SCPe finance costs + wkg cap               | C\$32m     | Total proceeds               | C\$660m          |         |         |
| Asset NAV5% C\$1700/oz                                                              |  | 1,838                                                                     |                            |                                                           | 22.2     |                                                  | Total uses                                 | C\$651m    | Buffer                       | C\$8m            |         |         |
| *Shares diluted for options but not mine build                                      |  | Market P/NAV5% 3Q22                                                       |                            |                                                           |          | 0.28x                                            | *Cash from options expiring pre first pour |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Share data                                                                          |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | Ratio analysis                                   |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Basic shares (m)                                                                    |  | 75.5                                                                      | FD with build equity raise |                                                           | 109.3    | Average shares out (m)                           | CY21A                                      | CY22E      | CY23E                        | CY24E            | CY25E   |         |
| FD with options (m)                                                                 |  | 82.6                                                                      |                            |                                                           |          |                                                  | EPS (C\$/sh)                               | -          | -                            | -                | -       |         |
| Asset value: 1xNPV project @ build start (C\$m, ungeared)*                          |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | CFPS (C\$/sh)                                    | -                                          | -          | -                            | -                | -       |         |
| Project NPV (C\$m)*                                                                 |  | \$1500oz                                                                  | \$1600oz                   | \$1700oz                                                  | \$1800oz | \$1900oz                                         | EV (C\$m)                                  | 528.7      | 392.2                        | 422.5            | 633.9   | 940.7   |
| 10.0% discount                                                                      |  | 1,176                                                                     | 1,311                      | 1,446                                                     | 1,580    | 1,715                                            | FCF yield (%)                              | -          | -                            | -                | -       | -       |
| 7.5% discount                                                                       |  | 1,341                                                                     | 1,492                      | 1,642                                                     | 1,793    | 1,943                                            | PER (x)                                    | -          | -                            | -                | -       | -       |
| 5.0% discount                                                                       |  | 1,534                                                                     | 1,704                      | 1,874                                                     | 2,043    | 2,212                                            | P/CF (x)                                   | -          | -                            | -                | -       | -       |
| Ungeared project IRR:                                                               |  | 41%                                                                       | 44%                        | 48%                                                       | 51%      | 54%                                              | EV/EBITDA (x)                              | -          | -                            | -                | -       | 31.7x   |
| Project NPV (C\$/sh)*                                                               |  | \$1500oz                                                                  | \$1600oz                   | \$1700oz                                                  | \$1800oz | \$1900oz                                         | Income statement                           |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| 10.0% discount                                                                      |  | 14.2                                                                      | 15.9                       | 17.5                                                      | 19.1     | 20.7                                             | Net revenue (C\$m)                         | -          | -                            | -                | -       | 38.5    |
| 7.5% discount                                                                       |  | 16.2                                                                      | 18.0                       | 19.9                                                      | 21.7     | 23.5                                             | Gross profit (C\$m)                        | -          | -                            | -                | -       | 30.4    |
| 5.0% discount                                                                       |  | 18.6                                                                      | 20.6                       | 22.7                                                      | 24.7     | 26.8                                             | D&A, attrib (C\$m)                         | 0.3        | 0.1                          | -                | -       | 5.9     |
| *Project level NPV, excl finance costs and central SG&A, discounted to build start  |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | Admin (C\$m)                                     | 22.9                                       | 14.8       | 12.3                         | 9.2              | -       |         |
| Group valuation over time^                                                          |  | Dec-22                                                                    | Dec-23                     | Dec-24                                                    | Dec-25   | Dec-26                                           | Expensed exploration (C\$m)                | 107.5      | 43.0                         | -                | -       | -       |
| Eskay Creek (C\$m)                                                                  |  | 1,539                                                                     | 1,639                      | 1,879                                                     | 2,253    | 2,321                                            | Finance cost (C\$m)                        | (0.2)      | (0.1)                        | -                | -       | 26.2    |
| Net cash prior qtr (C\$m)                                                           |  | 49                                                                        | 1                          | 59                                                        | (220)    | (232)                                            | Royalty (C\$m)                             | -          | -                            | -                | -       | 0.7     |
| G&A and finance costs (C\$m)                                                        |  | (90)                                                                      | (83)                       | (97)                                                      | (84)     | (42)                                             | Forex, other (C\$m)                        | (12.8)     | (7.9)                        | -                | -       | -       |
| Cash from options (C\$m)                                                            |  | 58                                                                        | 58                         | 58                                                        | 58       | 58                                               | Taxes (C\$m)                               | -          | -                            | -                | -       | 3.2     |
| Snip                                                                                |  | 64                                                                        | 64                         | 64                                                        | 64       | 64                                               | Net income (C\$m)                          | (117.6)    | (49.9)                       | (12.3)           | (9.2)   | (5.6)   |
| NAV FF FD (C\$m)                                                                    |  | 1,620                                                                     | 1,680                      | 1,964                                                     | 2,072    | 2,170                                            | Cash flow, attrib.                         |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| 1xNAV5%sh FF FD (C\$/sh)                                                            |  | 19.61^                                                                    | 15.37*                     | 17.98*                                                    | 18.96*   | 19.86*                                           | EBIT (C\$m)                                | (117.8)    | (50.0)                       | (12.3)           | (9.2)   | 23.8    |
| Gearing company NAV diluted for mine build, net G&A and finance costs               |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | Add back D&A (C\$m)                              | 0.3                                        | 0.1        | -                            | -                | 5.9     |         |
| 3Q22 1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^                                                          |  | \$1500oz                                                                  | \$1600oz                   | \$1700oz                                                  | \$1800oz | \$1900oz                                         | Less tax + net interest (C\$m)             | (0.2)      | (0.1)                        | -                | -       | 29.3    |
| 10.0% discount                                                                      |  | 1,583                                                                     | 1,755                      | 1,927                                                     | 2,098    | 2,271                                            | Net change in wkg cap (C\$m)               | (10.3)     | 4.6                          | -                | (1.1)   | (10.9)  |
| 7.5% discount                                                                       |  | 1,677                                                                     | 1,858                      | 2,038                                                     | 2,219    | 2,400                                            | Add back other non-cash (C\$m)             | 1.4        | (3.1)                        | -                | -       | -       |
| 5.0% discount                                                                       |  | 1,782                                                                     | 1,972                      | 2,163                                                     | 2,354    | 2,545                                            | Cash flow ops (C\$m)                       |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Gearing project IRR:                                                                |  | 38%                                                                       | 42%                        | 45%                                                       | 49%      | 52%                                              | PP&E - build + sust. (C\$m)                | (13.1)     | 4.8                          | (35.4)           | (179.3) | (296.3) |
| 3Q22 1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^                                                          |  | \$1500oz                                                                  | \$1600oz                   | \$1700oz                                                  | \$1800oz | \$1900oz                                         | PP&E - expl'n (C\$m)                       | (0.5)      | (17.5)                       | 22.5             | -       | -       |
| 10.0% discount                                                                      |  | 12.74                                                                     | 14.63                      | 16.54                                                     | 18.47    | 20.42                                            | Cash flow inv. (C\$m)                      |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| 7.5% discount                                                                       |  | 14.08                                                                     | 16.09                      | 18.13                                                     | 20.19    | 22.26                                            | Share issue (C\$m)                         | 137.0      | 65.5                         | 174.4            | -       | -       |
| 5.0% discount                                                                       |  | 15.55                                                                     | 17.71                      | 19.89                                                     | 22.08    | 24.29                                            | Proceeds from sale (C\$m)                  | 5.0        | -                            | -                | -       | -       |
| ^Project NPV incl grp SG&A & fin. cost, +net cash; *diluted for mine build equity   |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | Debt draw (repay) (C\$m)                         | (1.6)                                      | (0.2)      | -                            | -                | 436.0   |         |
| Production                                                                          |  | Y1                                                                        | Y2                         | Y3                                                        | Y4       | Y5                                               | Cash flow fin. (C\$m)                      |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Gold production (000oz)                                                             |  | 413                                                                       | 352                        | 457                                                       | 481      | 480                                              | Net change in cash (C\$m)                  | 0.8        | 4.5                          | 149.2            | (189.6) | 129.2   |
| C1 cost (US\$/oz)                                                                   |  | 609                                                                       | 895                        | 720                                                       | 654      | 587                                              | EBITDA (C\$m)                              | (117.5)    | (49.9)                       | (12.3)           | (9.2)   | 29.7    |
| AISC cost (US\$/oz)                                                                 |  | 689                                                                       | 976                        | 851                                                       | 780      | 634                                              | Balance sheet                              |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| AISC = C1 + ug sustaining capex, Y1 = 12M to Mar 2027                               |  |                                                                           |                            |                                                           |          | Cash (C\$m)                                      | CY21A                                      | CY22E      | CY23E                        | CY24E            | CY25E   |         |
|  |  | 40.3                                                                      | 45.6                       | 194.8                                                     | 5.2      | 134.5                                            |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | Acc rec., inv, prepaid (C\$m)                                             | 13.9                       | 7.7                                                       | 7.7      | 8.8                                              | 7.2                                        |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | PP&E + other (C\$m)                                                       | 100.8                      | 124.4                                                     | 137.3    | 316.6                                            | 606.9                                      |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | Total assets (C\$m)                                                       | 155.0                      | 177.8                                                     | 339.9    | 330.7                                            | 748.5                                      |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | Debt (C\$m)                                                               | 1.3                        | 1.2                                                       | 1.2      | 1.2                                              | 437.2                                      |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | 12.5                                                                      | 13.2                       | 13.2                                                      | 13.2     | 0.6                                              |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | 17.6                                                                      | 9.6                        | 9.6                                                       | 9.6      | 9.6                                              |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | 31.4                                                                      | 24.0                       | 24.0                                                      | 24.0     | 447.5                                            |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | 362.0                                                                     | 449.8                      | 624.2                                                     | 624.2    | 624.2                                            |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
|                                                                                     |  | (238.4)                                                                   | (296.0)                    | (308.3)                                                   | (317.5)  | (323.1)                                          |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |
| Liabilities + equity (C\$m)                                                         |  | 155.0                                                                     | 177.8                      | 339.9                                                     | 330.7    | 748.5                                            |                                            |            |                              |                  |         |         |

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**BUY:** The stocks total returns are expected to be materially better than the overall market with higher return expectations needed for more risky securities markets

**NEUTRAL:** The stock's total returns are expected to be in line with the overall market

**SELL:** The stocks total returns are expected to be materially lower than the overall market

**TENDER:** The analyst recommends tendering shares to a formal tender offering

**UNDER REVIEW:** The stock will be placed under review when there is a significant material event with further information pending; and/or when the research analyst determines it is necessary to await adequate information that could potentially lead to a re-evaluation of the rating, target price or forecast; and/or when coverage of a particular security is transferred from one analyst to another to give the new analyst time to reconfirm the rating, target price or forecast.

**NOT RATED ((N/R):** The stock is not currently rated

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|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
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| Summary of Recommendations as of November 2022 |    |
|------------------------------------------------|----|
| BUY:                                           | 50 |
| HOLD:                                          | 1  |
| SELL:                                          | 0  |
| UNDER REVIEW:                                  | 1  |
| TENDER:                                        | 0  |
| NOT RATED:                                     | 0  |
| TOTAL                                          | 52 |

<sup>1</sup> As at the end of the month immediately preceding the date of issuance of the research report or the end of the second most recent month if the issue date is less than 10 calendar days after the end of the most recent month